

Basics of Bug Tracking Tools

A bug tracking tool should have the essentials like:

- Reporting features
- History and work logs
- Lifecycle and progress throughout different stages
- Storage
- Visual representation like graph and chart

These are the aspects of good bug tracking software and some of them are Jira, Trello, etc.

Use of conventional and outdated system like Excel can encounter many challenges and are harder to maintain.

JIRA Software:

This software is primarily known as incident management tool which is also used for bug tracking. It provides tons of facilities like recording, reporting, real-time defect tracking, logs, and so on. This application supports methodologies like Agile.

Trello:

Trello is a popular collaboration tool that helps to organize projects. With the help of Trello, things like progress, who's working on the project, who's working on what project can be record. It provides various integrations for seamless and smooth workflow.

GitHub Issues:

GitHub Issues is a feature inside the github repository that is used for planning, tracking the progress of the projects. It provides features like:

- tracking

- collaboration
- flexibility
- organization

Severity vs Priority

Severity defines the impact on the functionality or user experience which is labeled as low, high or medium. It tells how the critical the effect is. Just like cancer have various stages and as stages progress, the more critical the situation is.

Priority tells how urgently the defect should be fixed. If it is of low priority, it's not that urgent and can be waited, but if the bug is categorized in high priority, then it's urgent to fix it.

Bug Severity	Bug Priority
Refers to the measure of the impact.	Refers to the order in which developers have to fix bugs.
Driven by the performance of software function.	Driven by business value and time to release.
Severity is determined by the technical aspect of the bug and its impact on the system.	Priority is determined by the business need and the urgency of the fix.
High severity bugs can sometimes be overlooked if they don't affect core functionality.	High priority bugs must be focuses immediately, even if they have less functional impact.
Severity focuses on the bug's impact on software.	Priority focuses on the bug's impact on the business.

QA, PM and Developer

Every role has each work and task assigned. In a well organized team, QA, PM and developer everyone collaborates with each other.

QA detects, logs, and reproduces bugs doing a proper documentation. Developer analyzes root cause, fixes the bug, updates status. Project Manager decides priorities, aligns fixes with business goals. Each role must have various skills to thrive in the field.

QA should have skills like problem-solving, attention to detail, will to make software fail,

PM should have skills like collaboration, leadership, communication, mostly soft skills but hard skills are also the essence,

Developer should have skills like problem solving, good with programming languages, frameworks, different environments.